Assignment Brief
Contemporary Business Issues
Academic Year 2026

Unit Information:	
Qualification:	**Foundation Diploma in Business / CS & IT (SCQF Level 6 – Equivalent to A Level)**
Unit Code & Title:	**HE9E 46** **Contemporary Business Issues**
Assignment Title:	**Assignment 1** LO1 - Task A: Report (Individual) LO2 - Task B: Report (Individual)
Results Reporting:	Total Marks: 100 Assignment 1 Task 1: 50% Assignment 1 Task 2: 50%

Date of Issue: 15-01-2026	**Due Date:** 15-02-2026

<u>To be Filled by the Student</u>

Student USN:

College Name & Site: JAIN College

Tutor:

Date Due:

Date of Submission:

*All work must be submitted on or before the due date. If an extension of time to submit work is required, a Mitigating Circumstance Form must be submitted.

Has an extension been approved? **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

If yes, please provide the new submission date ……/….. /……., and affix appropriate evidence.

First Marker:	**Second Marker:**
Agreed Mark:	**Refer: Yes / No**

General Guidelines for Assessment

1. Attach a title page to your assignment. Use the previous page as your cover sheet and ensure that you fill in the details correctly.
2. All assignment work should be prepared using word processing software and should be organized and clearly structured

Word Processing Guidance

1. Use a font type that makes it easy for your examiner to read, for example, Arial or Times New Roman.
2. Use 1.5-line line spacing. Left-justify all paragraphs.
3. Ensure that all headings are consistent in terms of size and font style.
4. **Use the footer function to insert your Student USN, Name, Unit Code, Unit Title, and Page Number on each page**
5. Use the spell check and grammar check functions to check your assignment.

Assignment Submission

1. Ensure that you give yourself enough time to complete the assignment by the due date. You must take responsibility for managing your own time effectively.
2. Submit an electronic version uploaded to the student learning management system on or before the stated deadline.
3. Submissions received up to 72 hours after the deadline will be penalised in line with JAIN College's Late Submission Policy. Thereafter, submissions will not be accepted.
4. If you are unable to hand in your assignment on time and have valid reasons, such as illness, you may apply (in writing) for an extension under the terms of the JAIN COLLEGE Mitigating Circumstances Policy.
5. Non-submission of work without a valid reason will lead to an automatic REFERRAL. You will then be asked to complete an alternative assignment. Your work will be capped at a PASS.

Declaration of Authenticity

6. Exercise meticulous care when incorporating the work or ideas of others into your assignment. Ensure that all sources are accurately acknowledged using the Harvard referencing system, both within the text and in the bibliography. Failure to provide proper attribution may result in an investigation and potential penalties for plagiarism, in accordance with the JAIN College Malpractice Policy

Statement of Originality and Student Declaration

I hereby declare that I fully understand the concept of plagiarism, which includes the use of another individual's work and its presentation as my own without proper and accurate attribution of sources. I further acknowledge my awareness of what constitutes copying or the use of another's work without appropriate academic acknowledgement.

1. I know that plagiarism is a punishable offence because it constitutes theft, and the consequences of plagiarism as outlined in the Malpractice Policy.
2. I understand JAIN College's plagiarism, ghost writing and copying policy.
3. I declare that all work presented by me for every aspect of this assignment is my own, and where I have made use of another's work, I have rightly attributed the source.
4. I acknowledge that the attachment of this document, signed or not, constitutes my agreement to the above.
5. I understand that my assignment will not be considered as submitted if this declaration is not included.

Student's Signature: …… **Date: ……**

Assignment 1: Report on Contemporary Business Issues

The assessment measures the attainment of learning outcomes through one summative task.

<u>Task A – Summative Assessment</u>

After the discussion, you are required to submit an individual report. Your report should cover the following points:

LO1: Explain the features and characteristics of Small and Medium Enterprises.

1.1 Small and Medium Enterprises (SMEs): Scope and Formal Criteria

- *Define what an SME is and explain the features of an SME.*
  - **Task 1.1:** Define Small and Medium Enterprises (SME), provide a relevant definition using recognized standards (OECD/SQA/EU), and to establish the operational scope of SMEs within the contemporary business environment.

1.2 Key Features of SMEs

- **Task 1.2:** Explain any three (ownership, control, finance, flexibility) key characteristics of SMEs with a specific functional application on SMEs from the E-Commerce platform.

1.3 Stages of the Business Life Cycle: Characteristics and Real-World Examples

- **Task 1.3:** Describe all Five Stages of the Business Life Cycle, along with any three key characteristics per stage. State a relevant example for each stage.

1.4 Business Objectives Across the Life Cycle: Purpose and Strategic Intent

- **Task 1.4:** Elaborate on any two objectives relevant to each stage of the Business Life Cycle.

Assignment 1: Task B (LO2)

<u>Task B – Summative Assessment</u>

LO2: Analyse business strategies of Small and Medium Enterprises.

2.1 Internal and External Factors Influencing SMEs

- *Explore the internal and external challenges that businesses may face.*
  - **Task 2.1:** Explain two internal & external factors and their impact on the small and medium enterprise.

2.2 Functional Activities in SMEs

- *Explain the role of the functions and activities within a business, and how these change in relative importance, at different stages of the business life cycle.*
  - **Task 2.2:** Discuss four (4) functions, eg, operations, HRM, marketing, including digital marketing, accounts/finance, IT, procurement and how their importance shifts at business life cycle stages.

2.3 Strategic Options for SMEs

- *Analyse business strategies appropriate for different stages of the business life cycle*
  - **Task 2.3:** Analyse two specific business strategies (e.g., digitalisation, partnerships) with expected outcomes in detail.

Note:

- All learners are required to participate in Assignment 1 (Task A and Task B).
- The assignment will be assessed based on the single report submitted for Task A and Task B.
- Your reports should cover all the learning outcomes and the assessment criteria.
- To understand the marking scheme, please refer to the marking criteria.

Marking Criteria

Learning Outcome	Task	Assessment Marking Criteria	Marks
LO1	1.1	Define SME Provide a relevant definition (OECD/SQA/EU) and the scope of SME.	**5**
	1.2	Explain any 3 (ownership, control, finance, flexibility) key Features of SMEs with a specific focus on SME from the E-Commerce platform.	**15**
	1.3	Describe the Five Stages of Business Life Cycle along with any three key characteristics. State a relevant example for each stage.	**15**
	1.4	Elaborate on any two objectives of each stage of the Business Life Cycle.	**15**
LO2	2.1	Explain two internal & external factors and their impact on the small and medium enterprise.	**10**
	2.2	Discuss 4 functions, e.g. operations, HRM, marketing, including digital marketing, accounts/finance, IT, procurement and how their importance shifts at business life cycle stages.	**20**
	2.3	Analyse 2 strategies (e.g., digitalisation, partnerships) with expected outcomes in detail.	**20**

The minimum marks required to pass this assignment is 40%